

Switch up your meal plan and try some new and exciting dishes that help you enjoy being in the kitchen again, or experiment with a few of your favorite restaurant meals at home using a copycat recipe. I recommend you start a Pinterest board specifically for this purpose. There are hundreds of recipes on Pinterest to try!

When you settle on ten to fifteen meals that the whole family enjoys, keep them written down on a Family Favorites Worksheet to reference every time you write up a meal plan. You can download the worksheet at

CreativeSavingsBlog.com/ExpenseResources

2. DON'T LEAVE WITHOUT A COUPON

One of our personal eating out “rules” is that when we *do* set aside money for a special night out, we have to use a coupon. If you’re like me and never remember to take your printed coupons, pull up the coupon on your phone and show it to the waiter or cashier. They almost always accept it, and you don’t have to worry about forgetting a coupon ever again.

In regards to where to find coupons:

- **Subscribe to Restaurant Mailing Lists** – I subscribe to a ton of email lists, so I almost always have a wide range of weekly coupons to choose from. I would encourage you to start a second email address specifically for this purpose, but I also use Unroll.me to “roll up” all my subscriptions into one email to limit the endless supply of notifications.
- **Sign Up for Birthday Freebies** – Many restaurants offer free food on your birthday, and usually include your entire birthday month as a valid time period to use it. That means you could eat for free all month long, and at a variety of restaurants! For the most up-to-date list of Birthday Freebies, visit